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HISTORY · The Cholas: administrative system

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? The **Cholas** ruled much of **South India** from about 850 to 1279 CE. At their peak (Rajaraja I and Rajendra I) they ruled the Tamil country, parts of Andhra and Karnataka, Sri Lanka, and sent a fleet across the sea to South-East Asia. Why study them? They gave India its best-documented **village self-government** (Uttaramerur), a clear **revenue and land system**, a powerful **navy**, and the great **Dravida temples**. Learn them as **Sources → Rulers → Administration → Politics · Society · Economy · Religion → Art and literature → Decline**.

1. Sources

Source	What it tells
Inscriptions	**Uttaramerur** (village assembly, Parantaka I), **Tanjore** temple walls (Rajaraja I's gifts and accounts), **Thiruvalangadu** (Rajendra I) and **Anbil** copper plates, **Meykirtis** (the praise-introductions of kings).
Literature	**Kalingattuparani** (Jayamkondar, Kulottunga I's Kalinga war), **Periyapuranam** (Sekkizhar), Kamban's **Ramavataram**, **Tirumurai** (collected by Nambiyandar Nambi), Pugazhendi, Ottakuttan.
Foreign notes	Chinese records of Chola embassies (1015, 1033); Arab traders' accounts.

2. The rulers, in order

Ruler	Years (CE)	Key facts
Early Cholas	Sangam age	**Karikala** (built the **Kallanai / Grand Anicut** on the Kaveri, won Venni; Pattinappalai describes Kaveripattinam).
Vijayalaya	c. 850–871	Founder of the **medieval Chola** line; captured **Thanjavur** from the Muttaraiyars and made it the capital.
Aditya I	c. 871–907	Defeated the Pallava king Aparajita and ended Pallava power; Chola power spread to Tondaimandalam.
Parantaka I	c. 907–955	Took Madurai (**Madurai konda**), defeated in the **Battle of Takkolam (949)** by Rashtrakuta **Krishna III**. His **Uttaramerur inscriptions (919, 921)** describe village self-government.
Rajaraja I	985–1014	Real founder of the **empire**. Conquered **Kerala** (Kandalur Salai), the **Pandyas**, **Sri Lanka** (north, capital Anuradhapura→Polonnaruwa), the **Maldives**; **Vengi** alliance (daughter **Kundavai** married the Eastern Chalukya Vimaladitya); **land survey** (1000

		CE); built the **Brihadisvara (Rajarajeshvara) temple, Thanjavur (1010)**; allowed a Buddhist vihara at **Nagapattinam**; titles **Mummudi Chola, Jayankonda**.
Rajendra I	1014–1044	Took the title **Gangaikonda Chola** after a march to the **Ganga** (Pala king Mahipala); built **Gangaikonda Cholapuram** as the new capital; the **naval expedition to Srivijaya (1025)** in South-East Asia (Sangrama Vijayottungavarman); conquered the whole of Sri Lanka.
Rajadhiraja I, Rajendra II, Virarajendra	1044–1070	Wars with the Western Chalukyas; Rajadhiraja died at **Koppam (1054)**.
Kulottunga I	1070–1122	Son of the Eastern Chalukya prince of **Vengi** (Rajaraja Narendra) and Chola princess Ammangadevi; united Vengi and Chola, so the line is called **Chalukya-Chola**; abolished tolls (**Sungam tavirtta Chola**); Kalinga wars (Karunakara Tondaiman).
Later Cholas	1122–1279	Vikrama Chola, **Kulottunga II** (Nataraja shrine at Chidambaram), Rajaraja II (Darasuram), Kulottunga III, last **Rajendra III**; defeated by the **Pandya Jatavarman Sundara** (c. 1279) and pressed by the Hoysalas.

3. The administrative system

The king was the head of everything, hereditary, the **Yuvaraja** was often named while the king lived. He was advised by a **council of officers** (**perundanam** = high officers, **sirutanam** = lower officers) and royal orders (**olai**) were written by the **olai-nayakam** and approved by the **Oluvai** (secretary). He toured and heard petitions. The state was a mix of **centralised** control of revenue and army and **local autonomy** in villages.

Chola territorial administration

Unit	Details
Mandalam	Province under a **royal prince or viceroy**; about 8 to 9 mandalams in the empire.
Valanadu → Nadu → Kurram / Kottam	Mandalams were divided into **valanadus**, these into **nadus** (each with a council of local landowners, the **Nattar**) and then into groups of villages (**kurram**).
Ur, Sabha, Nagaram	**Ur** = general village assembly (all taxpaying landholders); **Sabha / Mahasabha** = assembly of **Brahmin (brahmadeya)** villages; **Nagaram** = assembly of merchants in trading towns.

Village self-government: Uttaramerur

The **Uttaramerur inscriptions** (Parantaka I, **919 and 921 CE**) record how a Sabha was chosen. The village was divided into **30 wards (kudumbu)**. **Qualifications:** age **35 to 70**; owner of tax-paying land (more than about **a quarter veli**) and a **house on own site**; knowledge of the **Vedas/mantras**; honest. **Disqualified:** those who had served on a committee in the previous **three years**, those who had **not submitted accounts**, those guilty of **sins/crimes**, and close relatives of a candidate. **Method:** names of eligible people were written on palm

leaves and put in a pot; a young boy drew **one ticket per ward** (**kudavolai** = pot-ticket system, a form of lottery). Members served **one year (360 days)**. The members formed committees (**variyams**): **Samvatsara variyam** (annual), **Eri variyam** (tanks), **Totta variyam** (gardens), **Pon variyam** (gold), etc. Members were called **variyaperumakkal**.

Revenue, land, army, justice

Topic	Details
Revenue	Department **Puravuvarithinaikkalam**. **Land revenue (kadamai)** about **one-third** of produce, paid in **kind or cash**; other taxes (**kudimai**, **antarayam** on occupations, **vetti** forced labour). **Land survey by Rajaraja I (1000 CE)** and re-assessment of the land.
Land types	**Vellanvagai** (non-Brahmin peasants' land), **Brahmadeya** (to Brahmins), **Devadana** (to temples), **Pallichchandam** (Jain), **Shalabhoga** (for schools), Salabhogam.
Measures, money	Land measures: **veli, ma, kuli**; coins: **kasu** (gold), **kalanju**, **madai**.
Army and navy	Large standing army of infantry, cavalry, elephants; royal bodyguards (**Velaikkarar**, **Kaikkolar**); a strong **navy** made the Bay of Bengal a **'Chola lake'**.
Justice	Village assemblies settled most cases; the king was the final court; temples kept records.

4. Politics · Society · Economy · Religion of the Cholas

Area	Chola period
Politics	**Strong monarchy with local self-government**; vassals (Samanta); marriage alliances (Vengi); an overseas navy; the king worshipped as the earthly form of the temple deity.
Society	Caste was strong: **Brahmins** and landowners (**Vellalas**) on top; the artisan and trader groups formed **Valangai** (right-hand) and **Idangai** (left-hand) divisions, who often quarrelled; **devadasis** attached to temples; slaves existed; **Brahmadeya** villages were tax-free.
Economy	Agriculture on the **Kaveri delta** with **tanks and canals** (Rajendra built the **Cholagangam** tank at Gangaikonda Cholapuram); **guilds**: **Manigramam**, **Ayyavole (Ainnurruvar)**, **Nanadesi**, Valanjiyar; trade with **China, Sri Lanka, South-East Asia**; **Nagapattinam, Kaveripattinam** ports; textiles of **Kanchi**; temples were the largest **landlords, banks and employers**.
Religion	**Shaivism** (Nayanmars; **Tirumurai** compiled by Nambiyandar Nambi in Rajaraja's time; Chola kings were mostly Shaiva) and **Vaishnavism** (Alvars; **Ramanuja**, Vishishtadvaita); **Buddhism** at Nagapattinam (Chudamani Vihara) and **Jainism** continued; the **temple** was the centre of religion, learning, art and economy.
Art, architecture, literature	**Dravida style**: tall **vimana** over the sanctum, later **gopuram**; **Brihadisvara** (Thanjavur), **Gangaikonda Cholapuram**, **Airavateshvara** (Darasuram), **Nageshwara** (Kumbakonam): UNESCO **'Great Living Chola Temples'**. **Chola bronzes** by the **lost-wax** method, above all **Nataraja**.

	Literature: **Kamban** (Ramavataram), **Sekkizhar**, **Jayamkondar**, **Buddhamitra** (Virasoliyam), Tolamozhi Devar (Sulamani).

EXAM TRAP

Uttaramerur = Parantaka I, kudavolai; age **35–70**; **Mandalam → Valanadu → Nadu → Kurram → Ur**; **Ur / Sabha / Nagaram**; **Takkolam 949 = Krishna III beat Cholas**; **Rajaraja I**: Thanjavur temple 1010, land survey 1000, Kerala, Sri Lanka; **Rajendra I**: Gangaikonda Cholapuram, **Srivijaya 1025**; **Kulottunga I**: Chalukya-Chola, tolls abolished; land revenue about **one-third**; **Valangai–Idangai**; Cholas ended c. **1279**.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about the Uttaramerur inscriptions of the Chola period:
1. They belong to the reign of Parantaka I.
2. Members of the village assembly were chosen by a pot-ticket (kudavolai) system.
3. Candidates had to be within a specified age range and own tax-paying land.
4. They record the land survey of Rajaraja I.
Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. The land survey was done by Rajaraja I (1000 CE), recorded elsewhere, not in the Uttaramerur inscriptions.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (Chola ruler) with List-II (event):
List-I: A. Parantaka I B. Rajaraja I C. Rajendra I D. Kulottunga I
List-II: 1. Naval expedition to Srivijaya 2. Chalukya-Chola line, abolished tolls 3. Defeated at Takkolam by Krishna III 4. Built the Brihadisvara temple at Thanjavur

A. A-3, B-4, C-1, D-2

B. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2

C. A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1

D. A-1, B-4, C-3, D-2

Answer: A. Parantaka I: Takkolam; Rajaraja I: Thanjavur temple; Rajendra I: Srivijaya; Kulottunga I: Chalukya-Chola.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements about the Chola administration is NOT correct?

A. The empire was divided into mandalams, valanadus and nadus.

B. Land revenue was about one-third of the produce.

C. Sabha was the assembly of Brahmin villages and Ur of the general villages.

D. Local assemblies had no role as all power was held by the king's officers.

Answer: D. Village assemblies managed tanks, temples, justice and local revenue under the Cholas.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): The Chola kings are said to have made the Bay of Bengal a 'Chola lake'.
Reason (R): Rajendra I sent a naval expedition against Srivijaya in South-East Asia, supported by a strong navy.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. Naval strength and the Srivijaya expedition gave the Cholas control of the Bay of Bengal sea routes.

PRACTICE

A temple's walls record a king's gifts of land and gold, and its tall vimana, built in 1010 CE, is a UNESCO World Heritage monument in the Kaveri delta. This describes a temple built by

A. Rajaraja I at Thanjavur

B. Rajendra I at Gangaikonda Cholapuram

C. Narasimhavarman II at Kanchipuram

D. Kulottunga II at Chidambaram

Answer: A. The Brihadisvara (Rajarajeshvara) temple at Thanjavur was consecrated in 1010.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the Chola rulers in order with one fact each. 2. Draw the administrative chain and the Uttaramerur rules. 3. Write the Politics–Society–Economy–Religion table.

POLITY · Fundamental Duties; Amendment of the Constitution

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

What is it? Rights come with responsibilities. **Fundamental Duties** remind **citizens** what they owe to the nation. The **amendment** procedure shows how a living Constitution changes while its core stays safe. It is neither as **rigid** as the American one nor as **flexible** as the British one: a **mix**.

1. Fundamental Duties (Part IVA, Article 51A)

- **Source:** the **USSR** Constitution. **Added by the 42nd Amendment (1976)** on the recommendation of the **Swaran Singh Committee**, during the Emergency; **10 duties** at first, the **11th added by the 86th Amendment (2002)**.
- They apply to **citizens only** (not foreigners) and are **non-justiciable**: no court can enforce them and there is no penalty in the Constitution itself, but **Parliament can make laws** (for example the **Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act 1971**). The **Verma Committee (1999)** listed laws that enforce some duties. Courts use them to uphold laws and to read limits on rights.

No.	The duty of every citizen
(a)	To abide by the Constitution and respect its ideals, institutions, the **National Flag and National Anthem**
(b)	To cherish and follow the noble ideals of the **freedom struggle**
(c)	To uphold and protect the **sovereignty, unity and integrity** of India
(d)	To **defend the country** and render **national service** when called
(e)	To promote **harmony and brotherhood** and to renounce practices **derogatory to the dignity of women**
(f)	To value and preserve the rich **heritage of our composite culture**
(g)	To protect and improve the **natural environment** (forests, lakes, rivers, wildlife) and have compassion for living creatures
(h)	To develop **scientific temper, humanism and the spirit of inquiry and reform**

(i)	To safeguard **public property** and to **abjure violence**
(j)	To strive towards **excellence** in individual and collective activity
(k)	Parent or guardian to provide **opportunities for education** to the child aged **6–14** (added by the **86th Amendment 2002**)

2. Amendment of the Constitution (Part XX, Article 368)

Three ways to amend

- **Who starts:** only **Parliament** (a Bill in either House; **not** a State legislature). **A Bill needs** a **special majority** in **each House separately** (a majority of the **total membership** and **two-thirds of those present and voting**). There is **no joint sitting** to break a deadlock. The **President must give assent** (made compulsory by the **24th Amendment, 1971**). A State legislature can only **ratify**, and only in the third category.
- **Ratification** by **half** of the State legislatures (a simple majority in each) is needed for: election of the **President** (Arts 54, 55), the **executive power** of the Union and States, the **Supreme Court and High Courts**, distribution of **legislative powers** and the **7th Schedule**, States' **representation in Parliament**, and **Art 368** itself. Example: the **101st Amendment (GST, 2016)** was ratified by States.

3. Amendment and the basic structure: the cases

Case / change	Holding
Shankari Prasad (1951), **Sajjan Singh (1965)**	Parliament can amend any part including FRs (an amendment is not 'law' under Art 13).
Golaknath (1967)	FRs **cannot be amended**; an amendment is a 'law' under Art 13.
24th Amendment (1971)	Restored Parliament's power; Art 13 does not apply to amendments; President must assent.
Kesavananda Bharati (1973)	Parliament can amend any part but **cannot alter the basic structure** (13-judge bench, 7:6).
42nd Amendment (1976)	Said no amendment can be questioned in any court.
Minerva Mills (1980)	Struck down that clause: judicial review and limited amending power are part of the basic structure.
Waman Rao (1981), **I.R. Coelho (2007)**	Amendments after 24 April 1973 (including those putting laws in the Ninth Schedule) can be reviewed for basic structure violation.

4. Important amendments (remember the number and the subject)

Amendment	Subject
1st (1951)	**Ninth Schedule** added; reasonable restrictions on speech; land reform protected

7th (1956)	Reorganisation of States (A, B, C division ended)
24th, 25th (1971)	24th: power to amend FRs; 25th: Art 31C, right to property curbed
26th (1971)	Abolished **privy purses** of former rulers
42nd (1976)	'Mini-Constitution': **Socialist, Secular, Integrity** added to the Preamble; Fundamental Duties; Arts 39A, 43A, 48A
44th (1978)	**Right to property** removed from FRs (now **Art 300A**, a legal right); Art 20, 21 not suspended in emergency
52nd (1985)	**Anti-defection law**, Tenth Schedule
61st (1989)	Voting age reduced from 21 to **18**
73rd, 74th (1992)	**Panchayats** (Part IX, 11th Schedule) and **Municipalities** (Part IXA, 12th Schedule)
86th (2002)	**Art 21A**, Art 45 changed, 11th Fundamental Duty
91st (2003)	Council of Ministers limited to **15%** of the House; stronger anti-defection
97th (2011)	**Cooperative societies**: right under Art 19(1)(c), Art 43B, Part IXB
101st (2016)	**GST** and GST Council (Art 279A)
102nd, 103rd (2018–19)	102nd: constitutional status to **National Commission for Backward Classes**; 103rd: **10% EWS reservation**
104th (2019), 105th (2021), 106th (2023)	104th: SC/ST seats extended to 2030, Anglo-Indian nomination ended; 105th: States' own OBC lists; **106th: one-third reservation for women** in Lok Sabha and Assemblies (Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam)

(The numbers are as I know them up to the 106th, 2023. Check the latest list in current affairs for later amendments.)

EXAM TRAP

Fundamental Duties: 42nd Amendment, Swaran Singh, USSR, 11 duties (11th = 86th); citizens only; non-justiciable. **Art 368**: only Parliament; special majority in each House; **no joint sitting**; **President must assent (24th)**; **half of States** for federal matters. **Kesavananda 1973 = basic structure**; Minerva Mills struck 42nd Amendment's clause. **44th**: property right → Art 300A. **73rd/74th** (1992), **86th** (21A), **97th** (cooperatives), **101st** (GST), **103rd** (EWS), **106th** (women).

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Consider the following statements about Fundamental Duties:
1. They were added by the 42nd Amendment on the recommendation of the Swaran Singh Committee.
2. There are at present eleven Fundamental Duties.

3. They apply to citizens only.

4. They can be enforced by the courts.

Which of the above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A. Duties are non-justiciable, so 4 is wrong.

PRACTICE

Match List-I (Amendment) with List-II (subject):

List-I: A. 42nd B. 44th C. 86th D. 97th

List-II: 1. Fundamental Duties added 2. Right to property removed from Part III 3. Right to education (Art 21A) 4. Right to form cooperative societies made a fundamental right

A. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4

B. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

C. A-1, B-2, C-4, D-3

D. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

Answer: A. 42nd: duties; 44th: property right; 86th: Art 21A; 97th: cooperatives.

PRACTICE

Which one of the following statements about the amendment procedure under Article 368 is NOT correct?

A. A Bill to amend the Constitution can be introduced only in Parliament.

B. It needs a special majority in each House separately.

C. A joint sitting can be held to pass it in case of a deadlock.

D. The President must give assent to the Bill.

Answer: C. There is no joint sitting for constitutional amendment Bills.

PRACTICE

Assertion (A): An amendment affecting the election of the President needs ratification by the legislatures of half of the States.
Reason (R): The election of the President involves the elected members of State legislative assemblies, so it touches the federal structure.
Choose the correct answer:

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

Answer: A. Federal matters (President's election, 7th Schedule, courts) need State ratification.

PRACTICE

A Bill changing the representation of States in Parliament is passed in both Houses by a majority of the total membership and two-thirds of members present and voting. Which of the following is correct?

A. It can go to the President for assent only after ratification by the legislatures of at least half of the States

B. It becomes law at once with the President's assent

C. It needs ratification by all the States

D. A joint sitting can pass it without State consent

Answer: A. Representation of States in Parliament is in the third category: special majority plus ratification by half of the States.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the 11 duties in short. 2. Draw the three amendment methods with examples; write the cases (Shankari Prasad to Minerva Mills). 3. Write 10 amendments with numbers.

REASONING · Statement and argument; statement and conclusion

UNDERSTAND IT FIRST

Two question types. (1) **Statement and argument:** a question like 'Should X be done?' is given with arguments (Yes / No); decide which are **strong** and which **weak**. (2) **Statement and conclusion:** from the given statement decide which conclusions **definitely follow**. In both, use **only what is given**, not your own opinion or outside facts.

Type	Strong / follows	Weak / does not follow
Argument	**Important** to the question, **general** (applies to many), **direct** link, based on **facts or public benefit**	**Personal** or one case ('my uncle…'), **vague**, **emotional**, **copying others** ('others do it'), **unproved**, side issue
Conclusion	Follows **directly and definitely** from the statement	Needs **outside facts**, uses **extreme words** (all, only, never) not in the statement, or is only a **guess**

EXAMPLE

Either-or rule: if **neither** conclusion follows alone, and the two **contradict each other** (for example 'all are raw' and 'some are not raw'), then **either I or II** follows. If one can be true only when the other is false, they form the pair. **Example (argument):** 'Should plastic bags be banned?' Argument I: 'Yes, they choke drains and harm animals' is **strong** (important, general, direct). Argument II: 'No, my neighbour still uses them' is **weak** (personal).

EXAM TRAP

Do not use your own opinion. Words like **'all', 'only', 'never'** make a conclusion too strong. A 'Yes' argument is not strong just because it sounds nice: it must be **directly about the question**. Options: only I, only II, either, neither, both.

Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

PRACTICE

Statement: Should the retirement age of government employees be raised to 62?
Arguments:
I. Yes, experienced employees will serve longer and the pension burden on the government will be eased.
II. No, because my uncle retired at 58 and is happy.
Which of the arguments is/are strong?

A. Only I

B. Only II

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Answer: A. I gives general, direct reasons; II is a personal example.

PRACTICE

Statement: All teachers of the school are graduates. Some graduates are sportspersons.
Conclusions:
I. Some teachers are sportspersons.
II. Some sportspersons are graduates.
Which of the conclusions follows?

A. Only I

B. Only II

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Answer: B. II is the simple reverse of the second sentence; the sportspersons who are graduates may or may not be teachers, so I does not definitely follow.

PRACTICE

Statement: Only candidates who score above the cut-off in the screening test will be called for the Mains examination.
Conclusions:
I. Candidates who do not score above the cut-off will not be called for Mains.
II. All candidates who appear in the screening test will be called for Mains.
Which of the conclusions follows?

A. Only I

B. Only II

C. Both I and II

D. Neither I nor II

Answer: A. 'Only those above the cut-off' means the rest are not called; II contradicts this.

PRACTICE

Statement: Should the government provide free bicycles to all school girls?

Arguments:

I. Yes, it will make travel easier and increase school attendance of girls.

II. No, the government does not have money.

III. Yes, because it will look good on television.

Which of the arguments are strong?

A. Only I

B. I and II only

C. II and III only

D. I, II and III

Answer: A. I is direct and about the purpose; II is a vague claim without proof; III is a side issue.

PRACTICE

Statement: Some mangoes in the basket are raw.

Conclusions:

I. All the mangoes in the basket are raw.

II. Some mangoes in the basket are not raw.

Which of the following is correct?

A. Only I follows

B. Only II follows

C. Either I or II follows

D. Neither I nor II follows

Answer: C. 'Some are raw' leaves open whether all are raw or some are not; I and II are contradictory and exactly one is true, so either I or II.

RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

1. Write the strong and weak argument tests with one example each. 2. Write how to check a conclusion and the either-or rule. 3. Make a statement of your own with two arguments and two conclusions and label them.

NOTEBOOK PAGE · Day 7: write this from memory

Close the notes. Write these headings, fill every blank, then correct in a different colour.

HISTORY: The Cholas, Politics · Society · Economy · Religion

Area	Write
Sources	Thiruvalangadu and Anbil plates, Uttaramerur inscriptions (Parantaka I), Tanjore temple inscriptions (Rajaraja I), Meykirtis, Kalingattuparani, Periyapuranam
Rulers	Vijayalaya → Aditya I → Parantaka I (Takkolam 949) → Rajaraja I (985–1014) → Rajendra I (1014–44) → Kulottunga I → … → Rajendra III (c. 1279)
Politics	Mandalam → Valanadu → Nadu → Kurram → Ur; Sabha and Ur; Uttaramerur kudavolai; variyams; land survey 1000 CE; army and navy
Society	Brahmins and landowners on top; Valangai–Idangai groups; devadasis; slaves; Brahmadeya villages
Economy	Tanks and canals; land revenue about 1/3; gold kasu, kalanju; guilds (Manigramam, Ayyavole); China and South-East Asia trade; Nagapattinam
Religion and art	Shaiva (Nayanmars), Vaishnava (Alvars), Tirumurai; temple = centre of life; Dravida: Brihadeeswara, Gangaikonda Cholapuram, Darasuram; bronzes (Nataraja); Kamban

POLITY: Fundamental Duties; Amendment

- Part IVA, Art 51A: 42nd Amendment 1976, Swaran Singh Committee, USSR source, 11 duties (11th by 86th, 2002); only citizens; non-justiciable. Write all 11 in short.
- Art 368: 3 methods with examples; only Parliament starts; no joint sitting; assent compulsory (24th); cases Shankari Prasad to Minerva Mills; 10 important amendments with numbers.

REASONING: Argument and conclusion

Write: strong argument = important, general, direct, factual; weak = personal, vague, emotional, example-only. Conclusion: use only the statement; extreme words; the either-or pair. Make one example of each.